

Friends keep making plans.
They keep not making them too.

Friendship, in early adulthood, is *work*.

Suggesting.

Coordinating schedules.

Chasing replies.

1 in 3

young adults feel lonely at
least once a week.

75%

say they have *many* friends.



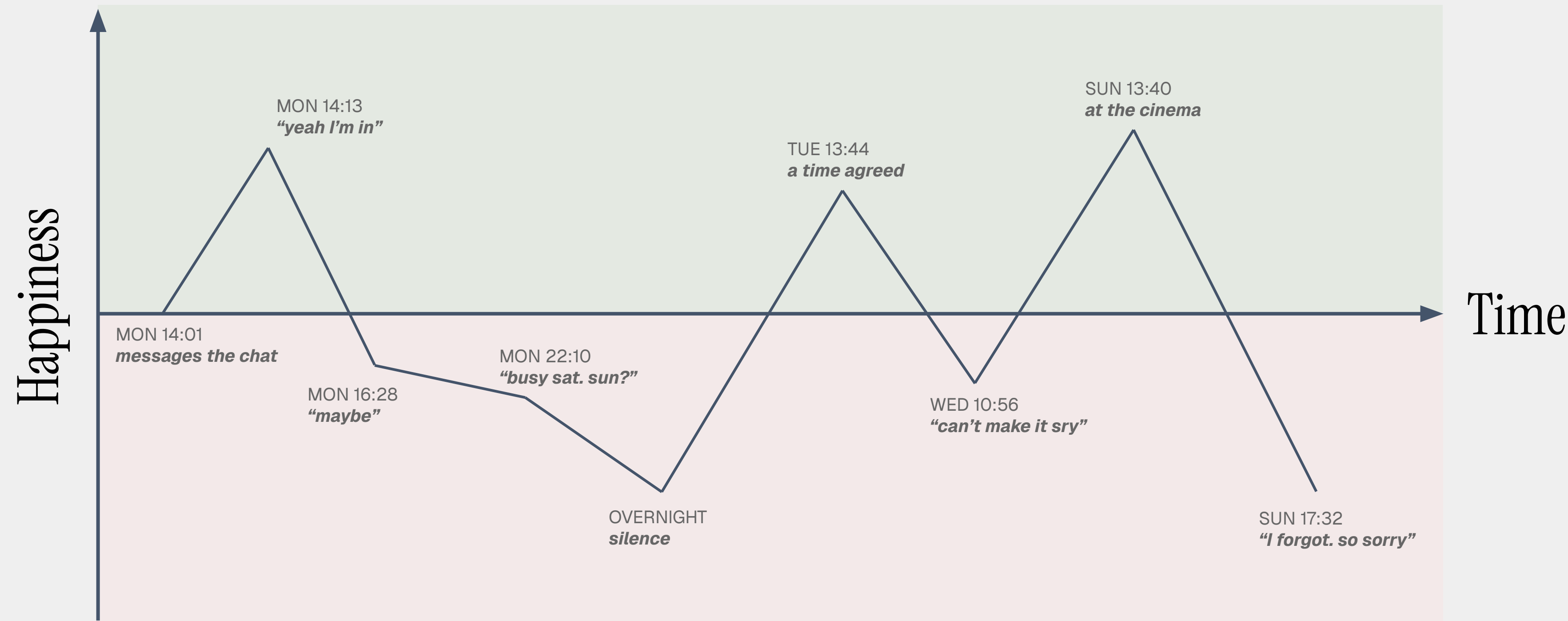
Vasanth

- Age 21
- Studies Law at St. Andrews
- Enjoys playing volleyball and board games
- Loves to cook for his friends
- Extroverted and reliable

The suggester.

One plan. From the *suggestion*, to the empty seat.

Vasanth's Christmas break, mapped as he felt it.



*He would keep organising without
complaint, if the effort felt shared.*

He is starting to suspect he is the only one
who cares about the meetups.

25%+

of lonely young people have sought therapy

a decade ago

7%

today

22%

of young people with one or fewer close friends

To learn more about the *problems* regarding meetups,
we *talked* to young adults.

“If I drummed up the plan, and it's taken considerable time, looking at logistics, pricing, whether everyone's okay with it, and then it falls through after all of that, that's quite frustrating.”

Luca, 21, the *organiser*
3rd year Psychology at Goldsmiths





“As days went past, [the meetup] got more drawn out, second thoughts crept in, and more and more people ended up pulling out.”

Chloe, 19, the *passive participant*
Marketing Apprentice

“If [I’m meeting] a friend of a friend, my attendance is conditional on my friend being there. I’ll wait for them to respond first, then decide.”

Matthew, 25, the passive participant
Care Worker



Two key takeaways.

1. SUGGESTORS

One sided and exhausting. *Awkward* to push for replies.

2. PASSIVE PARTICIPANTS

Uncertainty *compounds* uncertainty.
Some people's participation is *contingent* on others.

There are tools for RSVPing and scheduling.
They all rely on assumed certainty.

Partiful

RSVPS FOR SCHEDULED EVENTS

A plan already exists. People say
yes, no or maybe.

Doodle

POLLS TO FIND A TIME

Everyone ticks when they're free.
But available is not the same as
coming.

No one.

THE OPEN GAP

A way to lift the load off the initiator, and
let people commit on each other rather
than into silence.

*How might we help young adult friend groups
organise with **equal** effort, foster **certainty** in
followers, and make meetups **happen**?*

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